

Monitoring and Graphing Your Network With Cacti

Cacti, an open source network graphing application, utilises RRDTool, a data logging and graphing system for time series data. Read on to learn more about it.



Cacti monitors both the incoming and the outgoing ADSL traffic on my Cisco 877W ADSL router. In the absence of a router that supports SNMP, your own Linux machine or another device can be monitored. At the time of writing, the latest Cacti version is 0.8.8a.

Installing Cacti

Your Linux distribution probably includes a ready-to-install Cacti package. PHP and MySQL should be already installed and working. If they are not working properly, the setting up of Cacti will not finish.

The following steps are required to set up Cacti:

- 1 Ensure that the `date.timezone` variable has been defined inside the `php.ini` file (mine is `/etc/php.ini`) in order to avoid several warning messages during installation. Check it using the following command:

```
$ grep -i TimeZone /etc/php.ini
; Defines the default timezone used by the date functions
; http://php.net/date.timezone
```

```
;date.timezone =
date.timezone = "Europe/Athens"
```

- 2 The next step is to create a Cacti MySQL user (called *cacti* by me) as well as a Cacti database (also called *cacti* by me). I used the following commands:

```
mysql> create database cacti;
Query OK, 1 row affected (0.04 sec)

mysql> CREATE USER 'cacti'@'localhost' IDENTIFIED BY
'password';
Query OK, 0 rows affected (0.06 sec)
mysql> grant CREATE, INSERT, SELECT, DELETE, UPDATE on
cacti.* to cacti@localhost;
Query OK, 0 rows affected (0.02 sec)
mysql> grant CREATE, INSERT, SELECT, DELETE, UPDATE on
cacti.* to cacti;
Query OK, 0 rows affected (0.00 sec)
```